

Proposal for Installation of Disc Golf Courses at Wallace Park, Bulluck Park, and Mary Bridgers Park

Executive Summary

This proposal outlines the installation of professionally designed disc golf courses at Wallace, Bulluck, Mary Bridgers Parks. The City of Wilmington currently has **no disc golf courses**, making this project a unique opportunity to introduce a new recreational activity to the City of Wilmington. Disc golf is a fast-growing sport that is affordable, inclusive, and environmentally friendly. Installing disc golf courses in both parks will attract visitors, promote outdoor activity, and increase community engagement across multiple areas of the city.

Objectives

- **Introduce a New Recreational Amenity:** Provide Wilmington's first disc golf courses to meet growing interest in the sport.
- **Promote Outdoor Recreation:** Encourage healthy, active lifestyles for people of all ages.
- **Increase Park Usage:** Attract new visitors and regular users to both parks.
- **Community Building:** Provide a free, accessible recreational activity that encourages social interaction.
- **Enhance Park Appeal:** Offer unique amenities that set Wallace Park and Mary Bridgers Park apart from other local parks.

Project Description

The proposed disc golf courses will feature:

Course Types: Park Style Course – ~6500 ft 18-hole course (final layouts based on available space).

Design: Professional course design to ensure safety, flow, and playability.

Infrastructure: Tee pads, baskets, signage, and course map kiosks.

Accessibility: Designed to be inclusive for players of all ages and skill levels, and to make great use of the newly added crosswalk connecting key areas of the parks for safe pedestrian access.

Location Considerations

- **Safety:** Holes will be placed to avoid conflicts with walking paths, playgrounds, and other park amenities.
- **Environment:** Minimal impact on existing trees and habitat; natural features will be incorporated into each course design.
- **Parking:** Adequate parking will be considered for expected players at both parks.
- **Connectivity:** The new crosswalk will enhance walkability between park areas and make the course more accessible for families and pedestrians.

Benefits to the Community

- **Very Low Cost of Entry:** Players only need a single disc to start, and rounds are free to play once the course is built.
- **Low-Cost Recreation:** Free or low-cost access for individuals and families.
- **Tourism and Events:** Potential to host leagues and tournaments at Wallace Park, attracting players from surrounding areas.
- **Educational Opportunities:** Youth programs and school partnerships for teaching disc golf.
- **Economic Impact:** Increased park usage can support local businesses.
- **Multi-Park Engagement:** Encourages residents to explore both parks for a varied playing experience.
- **Youth Engagement Opportunities:** Our area has new disc golf youth league. There is a lot of effort in outreach but current courses aren't located within walking distances of the community limiting engagement. Please visit www.levelupdg.com

Relevant State & Regional Data

Metric	Data / Finding	Implication for Wilmington
Disc Golf Rounds in NC (UDisc)	North Carolina logged 665,896 disc golf rounds in 2024 in the UDisc system.	Arrowhead Park – 10,359 Rounds (2024) Castle Hayne Park – 9,357 Rounds (2024)
Number of Courses in NC	NC has ~400 disc golf courses	Large course base means the state is mature in disc golf infrastructure. Wilmington does not yet have courses, so it represents an underserved market.
State's Rank in "Course Additions"	From 2022–2024, North Carolina added 43 new courses , among the top states for growth.	Indicates demand is increasing, courses are being built, so interest is likely rising locally too.
Survey Participation	In several disc golf interest surveys (e.g., "State of Disc Golf", "Fandom Survey"), North Carolina is among	Strong direct interest from NC residents; may include people in the Wilmington area.

Metric	Data / Finding	Implication for Wilmington
	the most represented states by respondents.	

Budget Estimate

Item	Estimated Cost (Combined)
Baskets (18 total)	\$4,000 - \$6,000
Tee Pads & Signage	\$6,000 - \$9,000
Course Maps & Kiosks	\$1,000 - \$1,500
Total Estimated Cost	\$11,000 - \$16,500

Funding Options

- **Grants:** Apply for recreation and health-focused grants.
- **Sponsorships:** Hole sponsorship opportunities for local businesses, with recognition signage.
- **Fundraising:** Community events, tournaments, or crowdfunding campaigns.
- **City Budget:** Allocation from parks and recreation funds.

Maintenance Plan

- **Trash Management:** Regular trash pickup and installation of small receptacles near high-traffic holes.
- **Seasonal Maintenance:** Clearing debris, trimming vegetation, and addressing erosion issues as needed. The local club would assist in keeping the course clean of typical overgrowth and downed limbs.
- **Community Involvement:** Partner with local disc golf club to organize quarterly clean-up days and minor repairs.
- **Park Staff Support:** The area of the parks associated with the disc golf course can assist with maintenance tasks throughout the year to keep the facility in excellent condition.
- **Best Practice Example:** A site visit to Castle Hayne Disc Golf Course is recommended to observe a successful maintenance program in action.

Implementation Timeline

Phase	Estimated Duration
Planning & Design	2-3 months
Fundraising & Approval	3-6 months
Installation	2-3 months
Grand Opening	Within 12-15 months of project start

Conclusion

Installing the first disc golf courses in the City of Wilmington at Wallace Bulluck, and Mary Bridgers Park is a cost-effective way to promote outdoor recreation, strengthen community bonds, and offer a new amenity that residents currently lack. With its very low cost of entry and inclusive nature, disc golf is accessible to nearly everyone. With support from the city, local businesses, and volunteers, these projects can be completed efficiently and provide long-term benefits for the entire community.
